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For any technical questions on financial reporting to FTS, please contact our site editor.

INTRODUCTION

Since being established in DHA, in September 1992, the Financial Tracking Sub-Unit (FTS) has been responsible for financial tracking and analysis of data for complex emergencies. FTS is now one component of the Inter-Agency Support Branch (IASB) in Geneva, which provides direct support to the DHA Complex Emergency Division (CED) in New York, and to the field coordination programmes in-country.

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GEOGRAPHICAL SCOPE OF FTS REPORTING

DHA provides financial reporting for all of the countries addressed through UN Consolidated Inter-Agency Appeals. The scope of reporting is continually expanding to incorporate new emergencies while maintaining financial reporting for ongoing humanitarian assistance programmes. The current listing as of July 1996 is as follows:

AFRICA:

- Angola
- Great Lakes Region (Burundi, Rwanda, Tanzania, Zaire and Uganda)
- Sudan
- Somalia
- Liberia
- Sierra Leone
- Central African Republic

NEWLY INDEPENDENT STATES AND THE MIDDLE EAST:

- Caucasus (Armenia, Azerbaijan and Georgia)
- Chechnya, Emergency Situation in
- Iraq
- Lebanon, Emergency Situation in

ASIA, EUROPE AND LATIN AMERICA:

- Afghanistan (UNOCHA)
- Former Yugoslavia
- Democratic People's Republic of Korea

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TECHNICAL PROCEDURES

DHA actively collects data from UN Agencies, donor governments and NGOs. DHA also follows-up on specific pledge references carried in the media, quoted in pledging conferences, mentioned by in-country UNDP/DHA representatives or by the DHA complex emergency desk in New York/complex emergency support structure in Geneva. The FTS works under strictly defined procedures, which include considerable cross-checking and reconciliation of data from various sources. These procedures are detailed below:

- FINANCIAL TRACKING PROCEDURES

- Upon issuance of a UN Consolidated Inter-Agency Appeal, FTS begins a monthly process of collecting data and tracking the response to a given appeal. Financial data for each of the appealing organisations is collected by donor, sector, project, etc. so that it is possible to produce various financial reports based on user needs.

- It is important to understand that the summary Financial Tables are officially updated once every month and the information in the Tables is based on contributions reported/confirmed to DHA by the UN Agencies or other relevant organisations. Hence the note on all Tables produced by FTS, indicating

  "COMPILED BY DHA ON THE BASIS OF INFORMATION PROVIDED BY THE RESPECTIVE APPEALING ORGANISATIONS".

- Furthermore, FTS reconciles all financial data received from Agencies against donor reports. Contributions that are reported by donors in the standard "14 Point" Recording Format are included in the tables after they are confirmed by the Agencies or other relevant organisations. FTS provides donor-reported contributions that have not yet been confirmed by the Agency in a footnote. FTS can only report on contributions that are officially confirmed by the appealing organisation. This is necessary since often there may be a change in the total amount of the contributions or earmarking between the time of the donor announcement of the pledge and the final agreement between the Donor and the Agency concerning the contribution. Based on experience, the estimated time between when a decision is reported to DHA by the donor and confirmed by the Agency is approximately a month.

- It is important to note that according to agreed procedures FTS only reports the data as provided from the designated resource/finance person at the Agency headquarters. Therefore, if there are any instances when an agency representative in the field disagrees with the published data as shown in the financial tables, they should direct any concerns to the source of information at their headquarters. Although this procedure may at first sound "rigid":

  - it is consistent with the policy set by Agencies' Headquarters and agreed to by DHA, since June 1992.

  - it also tries to ensure that the donor community is provided with consistent reporting from one source, on the response to a Consolidated Appeal, whether by the field office, Agency Headquarters, or DHA (Geneva and New York).

- FTS also endeavours to report on humanitarian assistance channelled outside of the appeal framework (i.e. NGOs, ICRC, IFRC, bilateral, etc.). This information is based on donor reporting to DHA according to the 14 Point Recording Format. As FTS is dependent on the information reported to them, all tables indicating additional humanitarian assistance outside of the Appeal framework have the following note

  "THIS TABLE IS COMPREHENSIVE TO THE EXTENT THAT DECISIONS HAVE BEEN REPORTED TO DHA BY THE DONOR."

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PRODUCTS PROVIDED

- Monthly Reporting:

  Country-specific Summaries:
  Financial updates for each of the appeal countries are updated monthly and include two levels of data: (1) pledges made in direct response to the UN Consolidated Inter-Agency Appeals and (2) additional contributions outside the framework of the Appeals. FTS also reports on appeal funding shortfalls by sector, UN Agency and project, based on the direct response to those appeals.

  Consolidated Summaries:
  In addition to the country-specific updates, FTS produces a monthly summary of all UN consolidated appeals, their funding levels and percentage of coverage.

- Specialized Summaries, Graphical Representation of Financial Data, Detailed Database Output:

  In addition to the standard reporting mentioned above, FTS provides specialized reports and graphs for DHA/UN Agency meetings and special initiatives, donor information requests, requests from journalists, researchers and others.

  - Analysis of Donor Assistance in Response to UN Consolidated Inter-Agency Humanitarian Assistance Appeal launched in 1994/1995 and Analysis of Total Humanitarian Assistance Reported to DHA for Complex Emergencies in 1994/1995

  - Summary of pledging statements following pledging conferences

  - Detailed database output of donor's overall contributions for a given year and/or emergency.

- UN Consolidated Inter-Agency Appeals

  Beyond monthly financial reporting, the FTS staff carry out a considerable role in the process of formulating new and revised Consolidated Inter-Agency Appeals. Their work has included tasks ranging from proofing/cross-checking all numerical references in appeals, to assisting the concerned desk officer with programme-related issues and liaison with UN Agency representatives and NGOs. FTS staff have provided this support both by participating in a number of appeal formulation missions and through backstopping the in-country structure from headquarters.

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INFORMAL DONOR BRIEFINGS

FTS staff have already given a number of informal donor briefings on "financial tracking" to some Geneva-based delegates and other visiting delegates based in their capitals. DHA-FTS/Donor briefings are scheduled on request, and provide an opportunity for informal dialogue on FTS methodology, data available from DHA, donor information requirements and related issues of mutual concern.

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ENHANCEMENT OF PRODUCTS

Analysis of Donor Assistance:

FTS has received very positive feedback from several donor missions concerning its various documents on analysis of donor assistance to complex emergencies. These reports are also having the expected effect of sensitising donors to the benefits of providing more complete reporting of their contributions to DHA. FTS plans to continue producing similar type documents in the future and is also working on making the existing available electronically.

Lotus Notes Database:

As of July 1994, all monthly financial summaries of contributions in direct response to UN Consolidated Inter-Agency Appeals and additional contributions outside of the appeal framework were made available on Lotus Notes within DHA (Geneva and New York), on a Database within the applications section of Lotus Notes. The full set of tables are available in Lotus 1-2-3, Version 4 format.

Donor Information Packet:

FTS has put together a "Donor Information Packet" which is intended to make donors aware of FTS reporting as well as promote and clarify the use of DHA Standard Reporting Criteria (14 Point Format) for information collection.

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FUTURE OBJECTIVES

- To enhance the provision of the consolidated information by systematically addressing the problems currently found with the "14 point" system, including closer donor liaison with relevant counterparts in donor governments, developing clearer channels of communications between FTS and the donor counterparts, addressing other issues concerning exchange of the 14 point information, and enhancing the actual reporting format and procedures.

- To undertake a periodic analysis of the "reporting pattern" of individual donors in order to identify gaps and weaknesses and work on achieving more comprehensive reporting.

- To continue to provide consolidated reporting on the response to the Appeals which would also (1) systematically reflect upward and downward adjustments in requirements; (2) call attention to strategic shortfalls which would have a negative impact on relief operations as well as an analytical narrative that would provide a more global picture of the humanitarian requirements of the country in question (based on inputs provided from the Field Coordination Units.

- To improve donor reporting to FTS which would allow output of reports on coverage in specific sectors, whether through UN, bilateral or NGO channels. For example, the essential issue of concern to many donors in the agricultural inputs sector is not whether any specific UN Agencies received the assistance sought but whether the essential coverage was provided.

We appreciate your feedback.

E-mail our site editor with your comments and suggestions.

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Maintained by DHA (IASB/FTS) & DHA Online Team
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